



SAHARA STAR TOURS

PRIVATE MOROCCO EXPEDITIONS & BESPOKE TRAVEL

MARRAKECH • CASABLANCA • SAHARA DESERT • FES • TANGIER



IMPERIAL CITIES CIRCUIT

15-Day Complete Imperial Morocco Tour

DURATION

15 Days / 14 Nights

DEPARTURE

Casablanca

FINISH

Casablanca

TOUR STYLE

100% Private Tour

ABOUT THIS JOURNEY

Complete 15-day Moroccan grand circuit from Casablanca. Experience all four imperial capitals, the blue city, Sahara dunes, and breezy Atlantic coast.

DURATION	DEPARTURE	FINISH	TOUR STYLE
15 Days / 14 Nights	Casablanca	Casablanca	100% Private Tour

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Experience a night the heart of the Desert
- Trek camels and visit the nomad families
- Take pictures with the Barbary monkeys in Azrou
- Visit the Hassan 2 Mosque in Casablanca
- Visit the historical sites in Rabat
- Discover the blue city of Chefchaouen
- Guided visit of the Roman ruins in Volubilis
- Guided visit of Meknes, Fes, & Marrakech.
- Watch Sunset over the sand dunes
- Hearty dinner and party around the campfire (Berber Drums)
- Visit one of the popular cinema studios in the world
- Visit the UNESCO world heritage sites
- Visit Essaouira, Taroudant, & Agadir

DETAILED PROGRAM ITINERARY

DAY 1 arriving to Casablanca

The 15-day tour will begin at the hotel or airport in Casablanca. Following that, you'll visit the Hassan II mosque, which is constructed over the Atlantic Ocean and ranks as the seventh-largest mosque in the world. The good news is that it is accessible to tourists who are not Muslims. It's a fantastic opportunity to find an Islamic mosque. You will have a great chance to observe Moroccan craftsmen's deft work, which exposes the richness and beauty of their handicrafts. You will also visit the Museum of Moroccan Judaism and the Secret Medina. It gives a detailed account of the history, culture, and customs of Jews in Morocco. In addition, you will see other sights in accordance with your time of arrival. The first night will be spent in a nice hotel.

DAY 2 A tour from Casablanca to Chefchaouen

Following breakfast, your journey to Chefchaouen will start. On this route, you will visit Rabat, one of Morocco's imperial towns, on the second day of this 15 days tour from Casablanca. You will see the beautiful Kasbah of Oudayas, the Mausoleum of Mohamed V, the Hassan Tower with its unfinished minaret, the Hassan 2 as well as the Chellah Necropolis. You'll travel to Chefchaouen after lunch. Before you arrive in the foothills of the Rif Mountains, you will travel through a number of breathtaking sceneries. Once there, you will notice a majestic gate leading to a broad valley filled with blue buildings, which is Chefchaouen. In the middle of the Medina, a classic Riad designed in an Andalusian manner will greet you. It will be a good chance for you to walk there instead of using a car and discover it.

DAY 3 Chefchaouen Guided tour

After breakfast, you will set out explore Chefchaouen on foot. Numerous painters, including Eugène Delacroix, Maria Fortuny, and Henri Matisse, found inspiration in this city. You'll learn a lot about Moroccan culture and the background of the blue city from the tour. You will begin your investigation at the Chefchaouen Kasbah, which was constructed at the start of the 18th century by the fabled king Moulay Ismail. The ethnographic museum's stunning view of the gardens that round the Kasbah and its collection of old town photos and musical instruments will astound you. You will visit Plaza Uta el-Hammam after that. The square is surrounded by cafes and restaurants that all serve the same foods. After a long day of exploring, it's a tranquil location to unwind and observe the world passing by. You will adore this wonderful city if you enjoy taking photos. The city is known as the "jewel of Morocco," and numerous Instagram users praised it as one of the most beautiful places they had ever visited. Including Chefchaouen in your 15 days tour from Casablanca won't be a mistake.

DAY 4 A trip from Chefchaouen to Fez

After having breakfast, we will travel to the 3rd-century BC Roman ruins of Volubilis in the east. Some of the original mosaics have been kept in remarkably good condition here. This city was served as one of the most remote capitals in the Roman era. Now it is a landmark that tourists visit from all around the world. Next, we drive to Meknes, a wonderful imperial metropolis that was constructed by Sultan Moulay Ismail during the 17th century. You'll visit several beautiful sites like Lahdim Square, Bab Mansour Gate, Sahrij Swani (a sizable pool), and the Sultan Moulay Ismail Tomb. By the end of the day, you'll head to Fes. Green landscapes and grain farms will be visible as we travel through the long route before you reach the magic city. You'll spend the night at a local Riad in the heart of the old Medina.

DAY 5 Fes guided visit

After the breakfast, you will start your guided tour of the Medina; one of the biggest walled cities in the world. You will stroll through the winding lanes lined with ripe fruit, piles of spices, elaborately woven Berber rugs, and other Moroccan artwork. You will go to mosques including the Quaraouiyine Mosque, which Fatima el Fihri founded in 859, and the Andalusian Mosque, which was built in 860. Unfortunately, non-Muslims are not permitted inside, but you can visit the library and see the magnificent, hand-made tilework going back to the 9th century. Then you will see the fountains, notably the Nejjarine fountain, the Medersas (Koranic schools) that date back to the 13th century, Batha Palace, which is now a museum of arts and traditions, the Chouwara Tanneries, the Souks, including one of the busiest in the city, Souk Attarine, Bab Boujloud with its green and blue pottery, Mellah and the 17th-century Ibn Danan synagogue and the King's palace. You will then go to the tanneries, which are Fez's most famous landmarks. You'll be shocked to learn that leather is still prepared by artisans utilizing methods from the Middle Ages. It's unusual, but it allows you to see several Moroccan locations that have gone back in time. As you return to your Riad, you get ready for the next adventure.

DAY 6 A tour from Fez to the Desert

You will reach the Sahara Desert on day six of your 15 days tour from Casablanca. Since you will see a different region of Morocco—the country of camels, nomads, and traditional life—it actually will be the highlight of the 15-day. You travel to the desert via the middle atlas mountains after breakfast in Fes. Ifrane, a small, chilly city known as “the Switzerland of Morocco” for its resemblance to a Swiss ski resort, will be your first stop. Additionally, this city is one of the cleanest in the world, and nobody ever throws cigarettes on the ground there. After taking some shots, you will move on to Azrou and pause at the area's biggest cedar forest to observe and photograph the barbary monkeys. You cross the border to a different area of Morocco after lunch in Midelt. Before arriving in Ziz Valley, you will stop to take in the breathtaking panoramic view of oases dotted with tall palm trees as you cross Talghomt, which is full of lovely vistas and sceneries. It is a distinct scene from anything you have previously seen throughout this 15 days tour. You will arrive in the desert and your camels will be waiting for you. You then ride your camels out into the desert and you'll witness one of the most breathtaking sunsets in the world while trekking. You will be in the middle of the desert after an hour, where mint tea will greet you. You will spend the night in a luxurious camp where nomads put on dance and singing performances in which you can take part.

DAY 7 Our of The Dunes & visiting Nomad Families

The Sahara Desert is an incredible, mythic land that will make your jaw hit the floor! Whether you are looking for immense savage landscapes, beautiful sand dunes, Bedouin primitive camps, or distant camel caravans, the desert has something for everyone. It's not a surprise that its pictures evoke dream-like Arabian Nights and Lawrence of Arabia vibes. After breakfast, it's time to explore its neighborhood; your dromedary will be ready to take you over the Erg Chebbi desert's sea of golden sand to nearby location accessible by car where you will meet your driver. You start your journey by visiting the lake of Merzouga (Dayet Srijj) which is known for its high biodiversity. It is home to several exotic bird species including, flamingos which settle there between June and September. Later, you'll be traveling to the Sudanese-born Gnawa people to experience their music and way of life. You will also stop by a nomad home, where various Berber goods are sold at prices that are lower than those in the major cities. Of course, a knowledgeable guide will be present. You will return and be driven by 4 x 4 to your hotel for taking shower and rest. It is time to relax and enjoy the Sahara atmosphere before starting your next adventure.

DAY 8 Merzouga to Dades Valley

You will cross the rough Road of a Thousand Kasbahs, which stand up along this old caravan trading route like turreted sand castles, as you head towards Gorge Dades after enjoying a traditional Berber breakfast. The middle part of Morocco is one of the most thrilling and romantic places to visit. It is surrounded by lush river valleys, palmeries, and burnished mud-brick buildings that are alive with the bright color beneath a clear desert sky. Via Tinghir, we'll pass by spectacular escarpments and deep gorges as we make our way through the Ziz Valley. After a walk through the Todra Gorge, we'll stop for lunch at a nearby restaurant. In the afternoon, you will hover over Dades Valley, you will stop to look at the "monkey toes" rock formations. By the end of the day, you will have arrived to Boumaln Dades, where you will spend the night in a traditional Riad.

DAY 9 Dades Gorges to Rose Valley, and Ouarzazate

After breakfast in the morning, you'll go on a stroll to explore the Dades Gorge before traveling through the Draa Valley, which is home to several palm trees and Berber communities. It only takes a short journey to Dades Valley to observe additional breathtaking High Atlas mountain formations that are encircled by verdant fields of fig, almond, apricot, peach, walnut, and pomegranate trees. Rose Valley, known for its rose water and cosmetics, will come next. It is made from Damascena Rose, which is also used in several cosmetics, medications, and fragrances. We will reach Ouarzazate, where we will spend the night.

DAY 10 Ouarzazate, Kasbah Ait Benhaddou, & Taroudant

After breakfast, you'll go to Ouarzazate's largest Oscar Film Studio (Hollywood of Africa). Then, you make your way to the well-known Kasbah of Ait Ben Haddou, which UNESCO has designated as a World Heritage Site. Many international films, such as *Gladiator*, *Lawrence of Arabia*, and *Game of Thrones*, have used this Kasbah as their setting. You will go to this special Kasbah. After that, you will continue traveling west while taking in the breathtaking grandeur of the Atlas Mountains, passing through Taznakht, a little Berber town where you'll stop for lunch. Then travel to Taliouine, the capital of Sufran, where, if the time of your visit corresponds with harvest, you'll get the chance to meet residents in their fields. You'll arrive in Taroudant, also referred to as "the grandmother of Marrakesh," in the late afternoon. In contrast to other Moroccan cities, this one's Medina boasts a Berber and Arab souk, which you will explore while strolling through its narrow lanes. You will spend the night at a Riad.

DAY 11 Taroudant, Agadir, & Essaouira

You will depart Taroudant after breakfast and travel via Agadir to Essaouira. For a long time, travelers have flocked to Agadir because of its lovely, big beach. Before continuing to Essaouira, you will have a stroll along the promenade after lunch. The seaside road offers stunning views as you go. You can see herds of goats climbing the trees in search of argan nuts and leaves because the region is well known for its argan oil. You will arrive in Essaouira, also known as the "Jewel of the Atlantic," after making several stops along the coast. Spend the night inside a Riad in the Medina.

DAY 12 Essaouira guided visit

After breakfast, you'll visit the Skalla fortress ramparts to begin our day of exploration. Then explore the Medina, a UNESCO World Heritage Site, where you can find wonderful arts and crafts made of native Thuya wood as well as other items. Lunch is prepared in the Moroccan style, using freshly purchased fish. You learn about the souks, the port, and the stronghold of Skala. Additionally, you will learn about Essaouira's specialty, which is the artisanal processing and cutting of Thuya wood. You will move around the hundreds of shops as you stroll through the Medina's passageways. You ramble around the Mellah, the Jewish administrative center. You will explore Essaouira, popularly referred to as the "City of the Wind," which draws surfers from all over the world. The Portuguese, Romans, and Phoenicians all inhabited Essaouira. As a result, a significant influence can be seen in the architecture. Essaouira is a little town with a rich past. Many performers from Africa and around the world travel to a "Gnaoua music" festival every year to perform. In the second week of June, it happens. You'll have some free time in the afternoon to explore the main square and enjoy a mint tea at one of its cafés. Spend the night inside a Riad in the Medina.

DAY 13 Essaouira excursion to Marrakesh

You'll leave for Marrakesh after breakfast. You might observe a lot of goats climbing trees to eat Argan nuts and leaves on the route. This area is known for Argan trees and its oil is exported worldwide. You will stop by a women's cooperative for argan oil, where you can discover the uses and advantages of the oil for everything from cooking to cosmetics to medicine. You will check into your Riad in the Medina after making numerous stops along the way. You'll have some free time in the afternoon to unwind and wander through Jamaa Lafna's bustling square and its snake charmers, musicians, fortune tellers, and acrobats.

DAY 14

Marrakech guided tourMarrakech guided tour

We saved the best for last. Before ending your 15 days tour from Casablanca, you will get aboard a Moroccan Vespa to explore Marrakech's streets and sites like a local instead of tiringly lengthy walks, traffic congestion, or bus excursions! Step onto the back of a Vespa and you will get ready to travel around the streets of Marrakech. You'll pass by elaborate Islamic architecture, humming bazaars, magnificent blue buildings, courtyards, and historic souks. After lunch, you will explore some secret gardens as you zip through street shops and Marrakech's towering minarets! You'll learn all the insider tips and have someone to show you exactly how Moroccans live with a native leading the trip, plus it will be a pleasant, non-cliche approach to seeing the best sights in Marrakech! The city of Marrakesh transforms into a magnificent place with a vivid energy that is difficult to match as the golden tones of the sun begin to fade and the night descends with its chilly, refreshing wind, its sparkling night sky, and its promise of exciting times ahead. We will take you to some of Marrakesh's most well-known sights as floodlights illuminate them, bringing to life reflections and the play of light as the markets are transformed into outdoor food courts. As local entertainers perform all around you and your local guide entertains you with their tales, Jemaa el-Fna Square transforms into a spot where you can eat the best cuisine from the area. Overnight in your Riad.

DAY 15

End of 15 days tour from Casablanca

Your 15-day tour from Casablanca has come to a close here. Even while it makes us happy when a tour goes as planned, this is one of the aspects of our profession that we dislike the most. After traveling together for fifteen days, we develop relationships, share our experiences, and open up about ourselves. True, saying bye has never been an easy task. The last day's planning is based on the details of your flight. The driver picks you up after checking in and takes you to the airport, where you leave from Morocco with a variety of tales to tell.

INCLUSIONS & TRIP DETAILS

What's Included

- Guided city tours and monument fees
- Comfortable private transportation with guide English speaking
- Camel trek and the overnight in Luxury Camp
- Airport meet and great service
- Dinner at a local restaurant in Marrakech with Music and Moroccan dancing
- Half board during the tour
- Fuel
- 14 Breakfasts and 4 dinners in the desert

Not Included

- Airline taxes
- Lunch
- Drinks
- Flights
- Gratuities
- Travel Insurance, medical emergency
- Tips to guide and driver (optional)
- Anything not stated in included part

IMPORTANT TRAVEL INFORMATION

- Transport: Private air-conditioned luxury 4x4 or Mercedes minivan with experienced licensed chauffeur.
- Accommodation: Handpicked authentic boutique riads and deluxe Sahara desert camp with private en-suite tent.
- Tailor-Made Flexibility: 100% customizable. Timing, stops, and accommodations can be modified to your exact preferences.

READY TO BOOK OR CUSTOMIZE THIS EXPEDITION?

Contact our Marrakech travel designers directly for instant assistance, route customizations, or booking inquiries:

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